

The Normandy Landings

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1 The largest and most **ambitious** military **expedition**ⁱ in history was the invasion of Normandy in northern France by British, American and Canadian forces that took place in the summer of 1944. Even nature played a role.

i. Expedition in this passage means a long and carefully organised journey to a especially dangerous place. Military expedition: 军事远征; expeditionary force: 远征军

2 It took more than a year for military planners to **orchestrate**ⁱⁱ every movement of troops, artillery(炮兵), ships and aircraft and to set everything in place for the move that was to open up a second front in Europe. This would **liberate** France and open the way for the final **assault**(=attack, invasion, offensive, thrust) on Germany itself.

ii. Orchestrate 是音乐领域的词汇, 它表示将一首音乐改编成一个由管乐队(铜管乐器、木管乐器与打击乐器)和弦乐队(第一小提琴, 第二小提琴, 中提琴, 大提琴)组成的交响乐队可以多重合奏的乐曲; 用在文章中, 它表示要协调各路大军(海军、空军、炮兵、伞降)。Orchestrate means to organise or arrange carefully.

3 Everything was controlled; right down to the placement of **military decoys**(军事诱饵) across the English Channel to **fool** the Germans **into**ⁱⁱⁱ thinking the attack would come from Britain's closest point to France at Pas de Calais rather than in Normandy as planned.

iii. Fool sb **into** believing 这个词组要求同学们会运用。E.g. Mystery meat fools customers into believing that the meat they consume is what the label shows. 通常, 一般动词后面接 into doing 都表示 **被动地、被迫地** 接受。再比如: He forced me **into** marrying him! 再如: I will not let myself be persuaded **into** buying what I don't want! 再如: I successfully talk her **into** attending the concert! 此处的 talk 表示“说服”。

4 Everything was controlled, that is, except the weather.

5 D-Day, the code name given to the day of invasion, was originally **scheduled**(=arranged) for 5 June 1944. **This date had been arrived at**^{iv} by considering two factors -- moonlight and tide. The hour of the invasion would need to be near sunrise, when the seaborne troops would have a rising tide. This would enable them to land close to the obstacles that had been placed to **hinder**(=prevent, 阻碍) their landing without coming ashore on top of them. The paratroopers needed a full moon for **visibility**. The days with the proper tide-moonlight formula closest to the target date were 5, 6 and 7 June. The fifth was chosen for D-Day to allow a safety **margin**^v in case the attack needed to be **postponed**(=delayed).

iv. This date had been arrived at by considering two factors. 这个句子是对同学们以往所学语法的颠覆。在大学阶段, 大家要通过理解与分析来了解这个句子的语法概念。一般来说, 我们只能讲 This date had arrived. 日子到了。但文中的意思是表达的是“这个日子, 即 6 月 5 日, 不是随着时间自行流逝的, **而是通过多方将领联合定下的日子**。”既然如此, 从现在起一直到 5 号, 是由军事将领所推断出的, **而不表示任由时间逐步推进达到的**; 那么, 这个日子被定下来就需要表达成: This date had been arrived at by the Allied commanders' consideration of two factors. 所以说, 我们用主动句来转译它: The Allied military commanders had **arrived at** this date by considering two factors. 改成被动句, 就自然而然成了我们文中的样子。

v. margin 是一个必须要记忆的词汇。Here, margin refers to a duration of time during

which the attack could be effectively launched.

6 In addition to moonlight and favourable tides, calm seas were needed for the crossing. But an unusually stormy **transition** from spring toward summer that year **held out**^{vi} little hope that there would be a suitable break in the weather. It also meant the possibility that Operation Overlord, as the invasion was called, might have to be postponed until later in the year or even the following year.

vi. Hold out little hope or not hold out much hope 是两种固定表达法, 表示无望。E.g. Negotiations aren't holding out much hope of a peaceful settlement.

7 With the arrival of 5 June, the weather was so bad that General Eisenhower, supreme commander of the invasion forces, was forced to postpone the invasion by one day. When he met with his **staff**^{vii} to review their options, they were faced with the **grim**(=harsh, very serious 严峻的) reality that 6 June did not look much better than the original D-Day. The meteorological report gave **a thin ray of hope**^{viii} that a **lull**^{ix} in the storm would allow enough time to launch the invasion. **Consultations**(商讨会) went on late into the night on whether to press ahead. Opinions were divided. Finally, Eisenhower made his decision. "I am quite positive we must give the order," he said. "I don't like it, but there it is. I don't see how we can do anything else." Within hours, an **armada** of 3,000 landing craft, 2,500 other ships, and 500 **naval vessels** began to leave English ports.

vii. Staff 是一个形单意复名词, 形式始终为单数, 而意义可以是复数。E.g. An entire staff / a staff of eleven workers / 150 staff.

viii. A ray of hope 一丝希望, rays of sunlight 缕缕阳光; 上一篇“课文与词汇讲解”里, 我们学到了 a stroke of luck, a stroke of humour.

ix. Lull means a short period of time when there is less activity or less noise. E.g. a long lull in the conversation, 谈话中很长的沉默; a lull in the fighting 短暂的熄火; 原文的 lull means a short break.

x. 历史上最出名的 armada 是 17 世纪的西班牙无敌战舰队 Spanish Armada. 曾数次征战英国, 结果以失败告终。

xi. Vessel simply means a ship or large boat. 表示船只, 这个词和 vehicle 很像。Vehicle 表示各类车辆, 同样, vessel 也表示各类船只。

8 Meanwhile, **critical errors** by the German side allowed them to **be taken completely by surprise**^{xii}. Due to the bad weather, the German navy **cancelled** its usual **patrol**^{xiii} of the English Channel. Also, a practice drill(实战演习) scheduled for June 6 **was called off**(=was cancelled^{xiv}). The German meteorological services were unaware of the break in the weather. On the eve of the attack, many of the top German leaders were absent from their commands. Rommel, the general in charge of the **coastal** defences, was in Germany visiting his wife on her birthday, and several officers were some distance away in Renne or on their way there for a war-game exercise(战争游戏演戏=军事演练).

xii. Take sb by surprise means to attack or approach sb without warning. 袭击, 突击

xiii. 我们来做一个**词形辨析**:

- Pa'trol 重音在第二个音节。Patrol means the action of performing guards or maintenance of security;

- 'Petrol 重音在第一个音节, petrol means gasoline. 汽油;

xiv. canceled 与 cancelled 都可以。前者是美式英语, 后者是英式英语。同学们要记

住，美音都是时尚化的，删繁就简的。所以，简化的，方便发音的，都是美音。例如：

- center, -er 是最方便发音的英语词缀，所以这种写法是美音；而 centre 是英音；
- plastic, 是 plastique 简化版，所以前者是美音；
- dialog, 是 dialogue 简化版，所以前者是美音；
- program, 是 programme 简化版，所以前者是美音。

9 The **assault**(=attack) on Normandy began at 12:15 a.m., when the pathfinders for the American airborne units left their planes and parachuted to earth. Five minutes later, on the other side of the invasion area, the British pathfinders made their jump. The pathfinders were specially trained to find and mark the drop zones. The main airborne assault was to **commence**(=start, begin) within the hour.

10 The airborne attack became **confused**(being in a chaos 混乱的, 乱作一团的) because of **stiff**(=hard, vigorous, strong) winds and the **evasive**^{xv} flying of the transport planes when they **encountered** anti-aircraft fire. As a result, the paratroopers were **scattered**(分散, 散落) over a wide area and most missed their drop zones, some by as much as 20 miles. Other **complications** were caused by the **terrain**(=ground), and the worst terrain was on the Cotentin Peninsula. The Germans had **laced**^{xvi} the open fields with anti-personnel(手榴弹) and **glider stakes**^{xvii} and flooded the low areas. The flooding caused the most trouble for the Americans of the 101st and 82nd Airborne divisions(师), with many of the troops **drowned**, laden down by their heavy equipment.

xv. The verb form of evasive is evade. Evade means to avoid facing directly to 避免正面迎敌。文中表示为了避免遭受火炮轰击而采取的“规避式飞行”；

xvi. Lace 表示蕾丝，蕾丝是一种镂空的花纹设计。It is a fine cloth made with patterns of many very small holes. 小孔到处点缀，所以此处 lace 就表示布满。E.g. The open fields were laced with many stakes. E.g. The surrounding countryside was laced with villages and hamlets.

xvii. 我们怎么理解这个 glider stakes? Stake 表示木桩，而 glide 表示滑动，滑行，掠过。所以，以 -er 结尾的可以表示人或物，即滑翔机。那么用于阻碍滑翔机降落的木桩就叫做 glider stakes.

11 The airborne units were to secure(=make sure sth is safe.) the **flanks**(侧翼) of the amphibious assault. That meant capturing bridges, crossroads and coastal batteries. After accomplishing those tasks, the paratroopers had to **withstand**(=stand up against 抵御住, 扛住) any German counterattacks.

12 As the airborne units struggled to achieve their goals, the great **fleet**(=armada 舰队) made its way across the channel(此处表示 the English Channel) to its appointment with **destiny**. Leading that **grand**(=great) armada were the minesweepers. Behind them followed **a vast array of**^{xviii} naval vessels of every **conceivable**(=imaginable 可想象得到的) type. Never before had such a fleet been **assembled**(=gathered). Including the landing craft carried on board, the combined Allied invasion armada **numbered** up to 6,000 ships. **Approximately** 150,000 men were to cross the English Channel and land at assault beaches code-named "Utah," "Omaha," "Gold," "Juno" and "Sword."

xviii. 前面我们学到了 a stroke of, a ray of, 这里再记一种量词，an array of = a variety

of 各式各样的. E.g. a broad array of wines; an array of = a large number of, a vast array of problems.

13 The first areas of French **soil wrested**^{xix} from German control were a group of small islands **located** three miles off Utah Beach. Allied commanders were concerned that these islands could be used as sites for heavy guns. The men of the U.S. 4th and 24th Cavalry squadrons were **designated**(=assigned, 指定) to take the islands **prior to**(这是一个十分常见的高级词组, 就等于 before) the main invasion. The assault teams found only land mines. The Germans had left the islands **unoccupied**(=empty 未被占领的).

xix. Wrest means to gain with difficulty 费力夺回, 抢夺 E.g. He tried to wrest control of the company from his uncle. 他费力地从他舅舅手中夺回公司的管辖权。

14 For the majority of the assault troops, however, the war had not begun yet. After spending as long as 48 hours aboard the various transport ships as a result of the delay, many of the men were **miserably**(可怜兮兮地) **seasick** and in poor shape for the challenge ahead.

15 The naval bombardment began around 5:45 a.m. The air attack followed. The naval and air bombardments were designed to destroy the beach guns and obstacles, **pin down**(=restrict, constrain, 限制, 牵制, 羁绊) the enemy and provide shelter for the ground troops on the open beaches by making craters. Both, however, largely failed in their objectives. Weather conditions had improved, but they were not perfect. Because of poor visibility caused by low cloud cover, it was decided that the bombers would **delay** the **release**(=drop 投放, 发射) of bombs 30 seconds to avoid hitting the **assaulting**(=attacking 正在攻击的) troops. As a result, the bombs fell inland and missed their targets. Although the naval bombardment was more **accurate**, it was not much more effective against the **hardened**(toughened 坚实的) German gun emplacements.

16 The weather also was **partially**(=partly) responsible for causing some of the assault craft to miss their **assigned**(=designated) landing areas. Additionally, many of the landing craft and amphibious tanks **founded**(=sank, were buried) in the **rough**^{xx} sea. In the Omaha area, most of the craft carrying artillery and tanks intended to support the incoming troops sank in the high waves.

xx. Rough has many meanings. E.g. Rough sea means turbulent, wild sea, 汹涌的大海; a rough hand means a coarse hand, 粗糙的手; a rough terrain, or a rough ground means a uneven, broken or bumpy surface, 凹凸不平的地面。

17 At Utah Beach, however, **a strange stroke of good fortune**(a stroke of luck/fortune 这是我们上一讲学过的) occurred when the assault craft encountered a **southerly**^{xxi} current that caused them to land in the wrong sector. The German shore batteries that would have **contested**^{xxii} a landing in the original area would undoubtedly have taken a heavy toll. The landing at the new sector was **virtually unopposed**.

xxi. 一般来说, **Noun+-ly** 表示像, 似, =like, 例如:

Being like a saint or god: saintly, godly=godlike;

Being like a mother or father: motherly, fatherly, 还可以有 brotherly, sisterly...

Behaving like a king or a queen: kingly, queenly;

Comfortable as in one's home: homely;

Vivid, full of energy and lifelike: lively;

Being like a knowledgeable scholar: scholarly 像学者一样的, 学识渊博的;

The queenly bedroom of Qin Keqing might indicate her noble birth as a princess of a former dynasty. 秦可卿的似女王一般布置的卧室有可能意味着她是前朝的一位公主。

所以, southerly 表示来自南部的, 来自西部的为 westerly...

xxii. Contest means to oppose, challenge, 表示反击, 抵挡; 这个动词和原文下一句话的最后一个单词成反义词关系, 即 The landing at the new sector was virtually **unopposed**. Unopposed means uncontested. Virtually means nearly.

18 Despite difficulties, Eisenhower's gamble with **the elements**^{xxiii} was to **pay off**(=succeed 成功). The invasion forces succeeded in establishing a **toehold**(立足点) on French soil. **Reinforcements**^{xxiv} began to pour in, thrusting on deep into France. Within a year Hitler's **empire**(帝国, emperor 帝王), which he had **boasted**(=praised extravagantly 大肆吹嘘) would last a thousand years, **lay in ruins**^{xxv}.

xxiii. The elements 在此处是一个不常见用法。Elements(一定是复数) means weather conditions, especially violent or severe weather. E.g. Let's battle **the elements**. 与天气抗衡。

xxiv. 英语中表示“援兵”就是 reinforcements 这个单词。E.g. We are the reinforcements. 我们就是援兵。

xxv. Lie in ruins is a fixed phrase. It means to be completely destroyed. 它表示“被摧毁”, 是一个本身有被动意义的搭配。E.g. The town lay in ruins after the hurricane. 城镇被摧毁。